



Ceres and District Community Council
Minutes of the Meeting Monday 09 May 2022
Craigrothie Village Hall

Present: John Hudson (Acting Chair), Faith Nicholson (Treasurer), Alistair Ewan, John Borland, Amy Ross-Henderson, Christine Hudson, Cllr Margaret Kennedy, Cllr Stefan Hoggan-Radu and eight members of the public

Zoom: Moira Henderson, Fiona Hynes (Head Ceres primary School) and two members of the public

1. **Welcome:** in the absence of Moira Henderson (Chair - who was travelling but attended via Zoom) and David Beveridge (Deputy Chair - who was attending a veterinary emergency at his farm), John Hudson acted as Chair and welcomed all attendees, both in the hall and on Zoom, to the public meeting.
2. **Apologies:** Apologies were tendered for David Beveridge, Cllr John Caffrey. Apologies were also tendered on behalf of Rena Douglas (Ex-CDCC) by a member of the public.
3. **Elected and Re-elected Fife Councillors:** The Acting Chair congratulated our new local Fife Councillors, Cllr Hoggan-Radu and John Caffrey who are newly elected together with Cllr Margaret Kennedy, who is re-elected. The Community Council look forward to working with them and are confident of their continued support. Appreciation was also expressed to the work and support previously committed by the outgoing Councillors, Karen Marjoram (who is retiring from public service) and Tony Miklinski.
4. **Previous Meeting Minutes:** The minutes have been reviewed by Community Council and are confirmed as formally approved and can be available to the public.

It was noted that it would be beneficial for the minutes to be available on a website and Alistair Ewan request for a volunteer to come forward and make a website specifically for the uploading of Community Council documents.

5. **Approval of Additional Bank Account Signatories:** Currently there are only two signatories to the Community Council bank account, Faith Nicholson (Treasurer) and David Beveridge (Vice Chair) and it is advisable to have four. The signatories should be officers of the Community Council and therefore it has been proposed that Moira Henderson (Chair) and John Hudson (Secretary) should be added. This was approved and the Treasurer will arrange the necessary formalities.
6. **Ceres Traffic Consultation:** It was noted that the Community Council is still waiting to receive proposals from Fife Council subsequent to the on-site meeting between Community Councillors, Local Councillors and Lesly Craig of Fife Council.

The Community Council preferred requirements were summarised as being for a 20mph limit to be established on the total length of the B939 St Andrews Road through Ceres and out to the village boundary on the road past Woodburne up toward Teasses. The Councillors had been advised by Lesley Craig at the meeting that, whilst the restriction on the St Andrews Road was feasible, the limit on the Teasses road would change to 30mph at the end of South Croftdyke.

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Alistair Ewan added further details on other traffic management measures that had been discussed, in particular relating to a preference for box-outs rather than speed humps and difficulties in resolving the narrow pavement on the burn bridge.

A member of the public asked if “crocodile teeth” road markings had been considered as these are low cost and have been successful elsewhere. It was confirmed that these had been part of the on-site discussions and we shall monitor.

Fife Council were to consider these, but the actual proposals remain outstanding. Cllr Margaret Kennedy commented that the current workload is high but that she would contact Lesley Craig for feedback.

7. Traffic Accident & Near Miss Blackspots:

It has been reported that there are regular near misses at the New Gilston turn-off on A916 (near “G-Gate”) and that there has been an actual accident. Similar incidents have been reported elsewhere, including on Wemysshall Road, Anstruther Road and other locations in the area. David Beveridge has previously noted that many of these roads are used by cyclists or walkers, and that the addition of specific 40mph “Walking & Cycling Friendly Road” warning signs have been successful elsewhere. Cllr Kennedy suggested that Lesley Craig at Fife Council be advised about such crossing points with a view to reducing speed limits.

Cllr Kennedy commented that there has been concern about places where public walking paths cross busy roads and John Hudson noted that a local danger spot is where the popular Pilgrim’s Way crosses the busy and fast section of the A916 at Struthers.

It was questioned whether accident statistics are available and Cllr Margaret Kennedy suggested that the Community Council could contact the appropriate local police officer, who is Sergeant Helen Manuel, and she provided the email address. The Community Council committed to review further.

8. Ceres & District Community Trust update:

The Glebe: Alistair Ewan reported that the discussions with the Church of Scotland were now on hold because of the Church’s ongoing reorganization process. He stated that he intends to consult with other Trustees to try to buy the land and certainly look at all other options. Money was available through the Scottish Land Fund but this may have changed and the Community Trust will see what funds are available. Alistair Ewan feels that the new minister may be supportive of the project and a lot of work continues behind the scenes.

Ceres Burn Walls Update: The positive news is that the repair works are underway and being carried out by Fife Council. It was commented that the financing is limited and that this may impact on the extent of the work carried out. Alistair Ewan proposed arranging a meeting with Donald Grant of Fife Council to ascertain the extent of the works and the anticipated completion date. This is a concern with regard to the Ceres Highland Games, which will take place on 25 June, with regard to access, public safety and condition of the Green.

Millennium Woods Gate: Alistair Ewan is still trying to find out the exact situation with the application process. It is not clear as to whether the hold-up is with the National Trust or Fife Council.

Moor Road in Ceres: The stormwater drainage ditch is still obstructed by the earlier SGN work. Only SGN can do any maintenance work on the footpath because of the underground gas pipe. Cllr Margaret Kennedy stated that she would try to find out what is happening from her contact.

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9. **Complaints Regarding “Shrine” on Bow Butts:** There had been local complaints regarding a memorial “shrine” that had been placed on the embankment at Bow Butts, however it was reported that the matter has been sensitively resolved and it is now considered closed.
10. **Status of Grit Bin Removal from North Croftdyke:** The grit bin has not yet been returned. It has been queried with Fife Council but to date no information is available. Cllr Margaret Kennedy offered to enquire on our behalf.
11. **Local Authority Planning Applications:** The proposal for the diversion of the public right of way at Wester Pitscottie Farm was discussed. The proposal relates to the realignment of the right of way to facilitate a residential development. As the right of way is not compromised and will potentially be improved there was no objection at the meeting.
12. **Craigrothie Bus Shelter Storm Blown into Adjacent Field:** It was reported that Fife Council have removed the wrecked shelter, using a specialist contractor due to the asbestos roofing. The meeting discussed the options offered by the Council for a replacement shelter, including like-for-like bespoke replacement, a similar timber proprietary structure or a modern metal / polycarbonate shelter. Points raised in discussion were that the old shelter had character but lacked visibility, public expenditure was a concern and ultimately the opinion of the immediate local users was paramount. The replacement could not be actioned until new funding was available after 1 April this year. Cllr Margaret Kennedy volunteered to remind the appropriate person in Fife Council to provide images and costs of the options to facilitate a decision.
13. **Police Report:**

Summary of Police Report: The latest Police Report was issued in April for the month of March. It was noted that the report gives limited information relating mainly to crime statistics. It was agreed that the recent report is not sufficiently comprehensive.

Cllr Kennedy commented that the police do try to meet with Community Councils and ask what they would expect to see in the report. Alistair said he had already met and advised the police about what we wanted and he would try to locate the original email to follow up.

Other Police Matters: Excessive speeding was raised as a local problem. Apart from the previously minuted comments for Ceres, there are also serious concerns about speeding through Craigrothie both on the A916 Cupar Road and the B939 Ceres Road. Motorists continue to speed into Craigrothie on the A916 and this is also a problem at the Chance Inn junction.

Faith Nicholson enquired who are local community police officers are and a member of the public suggested that their presence would serve as a deterrent to anti-social behaviour. Cllr Margaret Kennedy said that community police officers had been to both Cults and Blebo Craigs, and also suggested that a “coffee with a cop” event might be beneficial. Faith Nicholson also recalled previous positive involvement of police in the community with a football match.

14. **Local Road Maintenance Works:** The resurfacing work on the A916 from Craigrothie to Montrave is nearing completion and the main road is fully open.

The badly repaired potholes on the B939 in Ceres located on the burn bridge and the junction by the Ceres Inn are in poor condition. John Hudson commented that this was noted to Lesley Craig at the 24 February on-site meeting, but it is still not resolved. Both Cllr Kennedy and a member of the public suggested using the Fife Council website to notify road maintenance problems because they both noted it is generally successful.

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Dilapidated / Collapsed Road Signs: The good news is that some signs on the approach to Craigrothie have been refixed on new posts and are now in good condition. However, other signs in the area are still dilapidated or collapsed and therefore potentially hazardous. Cllr Kennedy suggested reporting these directly on-line where they can be pinpointed on a map.

Blocked Gullies: A Ceres resident has raised the issue of blocked gullies on the road past Woodburne up towards Teasses and that this has caused localised flooding on the road and in Ceres during heavy rainfall. Cllr Kennedy suggested that the Community Council may wish to refer this to Fife Council and John Hudson will contact the relevant person in this regard

15. **Resilience Groups:** Amy Ross-Henderson reported that Craigrothie Village Hall is looking to liaise with Blebo Craigs to establish Craigrothie Village Hall as a centre. She advised that a local newsletter is being prepared that will identify progress.
16. **Fireworks:** The question of whether or not a public firework display should be arranged for 5 November was discussed in some detail.

Cllr Stefan Hoggan-Radu commented that the Scottish Government is in the process of passing legislation to ban the sale of fireworks to the general public and, whilst this may not affect 2022, it will not be a long-term issue.

Cllr Kennedy stated that organised displays are preferable to private events and in feedback from last year she commented that the public displays were not overly noisy.

Alistair Ewan advised that it would cost the CDCC more about £2,200 for a display in Ceres. Amy Ross-Henderson suggested that we ask the public if they want such a display and question how the funds would be raised. A member of the public suggested that current austerity may discourage private events and also suggested asking the community via Facebook if they would be prepared to make donations.

17. **Queen's Platinum Jubilee Celebration Plans:** A sub-committee discussed several ideas but ultimately a large scale event was not feasible. Therefore it was proposed to host a "Picnic on the Green" event on Saturday 04 June, which would be open to all on a "bring-your-own picnic" basis. It was agreed that barbeques would not be allowed. Alistair Ewan and Amy Ross-Henderson agreed to liaise with the school and organise children's races at the event, possibly including a duck race. The bunting for the Ceres Highland Games will be put up early for the "Picnic". Amy Ross-Henderson will arrange for a promotional flyer.

Headteacher Fiona Hynes said that she would like the school to be involved and suggested they hold an event at the school on Thursday 02 June, which would involve the elderly in the community.

18. **Annual Community Bus Trip:** Generally, the meeting was positive towards restarting annual Community Bus Trips for the Elderly. Jean Nicholson is of the opinion that it would be welcomed and volunteered to sound out local interest. The cost of the bus used to be approximately £500 but this will no doubt be higher now due to general inflation and fuel costs. Funding previously had been supported by the annual duck race, which was suspended due to Covid, but could be used if reinstated at the Picnic on the Green. Other potential sources of funding were discussed.
19. **AOB**
- 16.1 Amy Ross-Henderson asked if bird deterrent spikes could be installed on the frame over the swings in the Craigrothie children's park where the bird dropping are a constant problem. Cllr Kennedy gave the name and contact details of the relevant person in Fife Council.

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16.2 A recent problem of youths knocking, kicking and barging on the doors of residential property in Ceres was raised. It was noted that the police were contacted. Headteacher Fiona Hynes stated that she intended to reinforce positive behaviour among the children in her schools.

Date of next meeting: 11 July 2022 at 7.30pm at Ceres Memorial Hall and also on Zoom. Join our mailing list or keep an eye on our social media.

Meeting ended 9.00 pm.

Minutes taken by C & J Hudson